

# Israa Hashem

## CONTACT INFORMATION

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Department of Economics, Concordia University  
1455 de Maisonneuve Blvd. West  
Montréal, QC H3G 1M8, Canada

*Email:* [israa.hashem@mail.concordia.ca](mailto:israa.hashem@mail.concordia.ca)  
*Website:* [israahashem.github.io](https://israahashem.github.io)

## EDUCATION

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Ph.D. in Economics</b> , Concordia University                                  | 2027 (expected) |
| Dissertation: <i>Essays in the Economics of Education and Market Design</i>       |                 |
| Supervisors: Szilvia Pápai and Gabrielle Vasey                                    |                 |
| Parental leave: May 2024 – Dec 2024; May 2025 – Aug 2025                          |                 |
| <b>M.A. in Applied Economics</b> (High Distinction), Lebanese American University | 2018 – 2020     |
| <b>B.Sc. in Mathematics</b> (Distinction), Lebanese American University           | 2014 – 2018     |
| <b>Teaching Diploma</b> , Lebanese American University                            | 2017 – 2018     |

## RESEARCH FIELDS

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Primary: Economics of Education, Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics  
Secondary: Market Design

## JOB MARKET PAPER

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### Does Having an Older Sister Matter? Sibling Sex, School Achievement, and Parental Investment

Siblings share much of childhood, yet we know far less about how they shape each other's learning than about the role of parents, schools, or peers. I study whether having an older sister rather than an older brother affects second-born children's school achievement and how parents invest in their schooling. Using British Columbia school records linked to the Census to identify siblings, and exploiting the as-good-as-random sex of the first-born, I examine second-borns' Foundation Skills Assessment scores in reading, writing and numeracy in Grades 4 and 7, as well as their enrollment in French immersion. I also compare second-borns with their first-born siblings to ask whether having an older sister offsets part of the birth-order gap in achievement. Results are pending Statistics Canada disclosure review.

## WORKING PAPERS

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### Intergenerational Educational Mobility and Field-of-Study Choice in Immigrant and Canadian-Born Families

Immigrant parents in Canada are highly educated and concentrated in STEM fields, but do their children follow the same paths? Using the Survey of Labour and Income Dynamics, I find strong persistence in degree attainment across generations, but weaker persistence for children of immigrant fathers, pointing to higher educational mobility among second-generation immigrants. First-generation immigrants sort clearly into STEM, yet this sorting does not carry over to the second generation, whose degree choices converge with those of the Canadian-born. These findings have implications for how immigration shapes Canada's skill composition over time.

## When Does a Stable and Pareto-Efficient Matching Exist?

with Szilvia Pápai

We study when stability and Pareto efficiency are compatible in matching markets, a question that arises naturally in school choice and other priority-based allocation problems. Even the student-optimal stable matching may leave large welfare improvements available to students. We develop constructive procedures that use preferences and priorities to determine exactly when a stable and Pareto-efficient matching exists, and identify when the outcome of a deferred-acceptance-type procedure is already Pareto efficient for the students.

## PUBLICATIONS

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Polluting Resource Extraction and Climate Risk (with Walid Marrouch). *Natural Resource Modeling*, 2023, 36(1), e12354. [doi:10.1111/nrm.12354](https://doi.org/10.1111/nrm.12354)

## CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 18th International Meeting of the Society for Social Choice and Welfare, Tokyo, Japan | 2026 |
| 20th CIREQ-CIRANO Ph.D. Students' Conference, Montréal                                | 2026 |
| CIREQ Interdisciplinary PhD Conference in Applied Market Design, Montréal             | 2026 |
| Emergence Excellence Conference                                                       | 2025 |
| Concordia Graduate Student Seminar                                                    | 2025 |

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Research Assistant to Gabrielle Vasey, Concordia University                            | 2025        |
| Research Assistant, UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia (ESCWA), Beirut | 2019 – 2020 |
| Research Assistant, Lebanese American University                                       | 2018 – 2020 |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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*Course Instructor*, Concordia University

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|------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| ECON 302: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory II | Winter 2027 (Upcoming) |
| ECON 301: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory I  | Winter 2026            |

*Teaching Assistant*, Concordia University

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|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| ECON 421: Econometrics (tutorials)             | Fall 2026                         |
| ECON 301: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory I  | Summer 2026                       |
| ECON 302: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory II | Fall 2025                         |
| ECON 440: Economic Design                      | Fall 2025, Winter 2025, Fall 2022 |
| ECON 326: Mathematics for Economists           | Winter 2025, Fall 2023            |
| ECON 695: Economic Design (Graduate)           | Winter 2025, Winter 2022          |
| ECON 491: Advanced Environmental Economics     | Winter 2024                       |
| ECON 425: Advanced Mathematics for Economists  | Winter 2023                       |
| ECON 437: Economics of Public Expenditure      | Winter 2023                       |
| ECON 464: Game Theory                          | Summer 2022                       |
| ECON 201: Introduction to Microeconomics       | Fall 2020 – Fall 2021             |

## FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| FRQSC Doctoral Scholarship, Fonds de Recherche du Québec – Société et Culture | 2024 – 2026 |
| First Prize, Economics Graduate Research Day, Concordia University            | 2025        |
| FAS Graduate Fellowship, Concordia University                                 | 2020 – 2024 |
| International Tuition Award of Excellence, Concordia University               | 2020 – 2024 |
| Merit Scholarship, Concordia University                                       | 2020 – 2021 |
| US MEPI Tomorrow's Leaders Graduate Scholarship                               | 2018        |
| Spirit of Service Award, Lebanese American University                         | 2016        |
| USAID University Scholarship Program (Full Scholarship)                       | 2014        |

## PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

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| Econometric Society Summer School in Dynamic Structural Econometrics: Market Design, MIT | 2023 |
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## SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

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Software: Stata, R, LaTeX  
Data: Confidential linked administrative microdata (BC student records, Census);  
longitudinal survey data (SLID); Statistics Canada Research Data Centre (RDC)  
Languages: Arabic (native), English (fluent), French (beginner)

## REFERENCES

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### **Szilvia Pápai**

Professor of Economics  
Concordia University  
[szilvia.papai@concordia.ca](mailto:szilvia.papai@concordia.ca)

### **Gabrielle Vasey**

Assistant Professor of Economics  
Concordia University  
[gabrielle.vasey@concordia.ca](mailto:gabrielle.vasey@concordia.ca)

### **Jorgen Hansen**

Professor of Economics  
Concordia University  
[Jorgen.Hansen@concordia.ca](mailto:Jorgen.Hansen@concordia.ca)